

OpenText ALM / Quality Center

Enterprise requirements, test execution and defect management — evolution of HP ALM / Quality Center.

What it is

OpenText Application Quality Management evolved from ALM/Quality Center, historically known as HP ALM and Micro Focus ALM. It centralizes requirements, test planning, execution, defects and traceability.

Official site and documentation

Use the official OpenText ALM / Quality Center source as the primary reference:

<https://www.opentext.com/products/application-quality-management>. Official documentation should be the first source for installation, supported versions, syntax changes and new features.

QA workflow

A classic flow uses Requirements, Test Plan, Test Lab and Defects. QA links requirements to tests, organizes executions by cycle/build and connects failures to defects.

Getting started

ALM/QC is commonly provided by an organization as on-premises or SaaS. Confirm the supported version, URL, project/domain, permissions and corporate documentation before configuration.

Test Plan and Test Lab

Test Plan organizes reusable tests and steps; Test Lab organizes test sets, cycles and executions.

Defects and traceability

Defects captures failures, severity, priority, ownership and evidence while links support coverage and impact analysis.

Good practices

Standardize fields, naming, cycles and evidence. Use permissions, filters, dashboards and traceability to support release decisions.

Installation and configuration - overview

Always use the official website and documentation. Check prerequisites and compatible versions, install for your operating system, configure environment variables or PATH only when required, validate the installation with the recommended command or screen, and run a first project/test before integrating it into the QA workflow.

How to start safely

Start from the official OpenText ALM / Quality Center site and documentation. Confirm prerequisites, supported versions, operating system and required permissions. Learn in a controlled environment before using it in a critical workflow.

First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in OpenText ALM / Quality Center, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

Using it in a real project

Define where OpenText ALM / Quality Center fits, who owns configuration, how credentials and data are handled and how results are shared. Integrate it into the team workflow instead of creating an isolated activity.

Adoption good practices

Standardize versions and configuration, document important decisions, keep secrets out of code and preserve reproducible examples. Reassess whether OpenText ALM / Quality Center still delivers value as the product evolves.

Common issues and troubleshooting

When OpenText ALM / Quality Center fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.